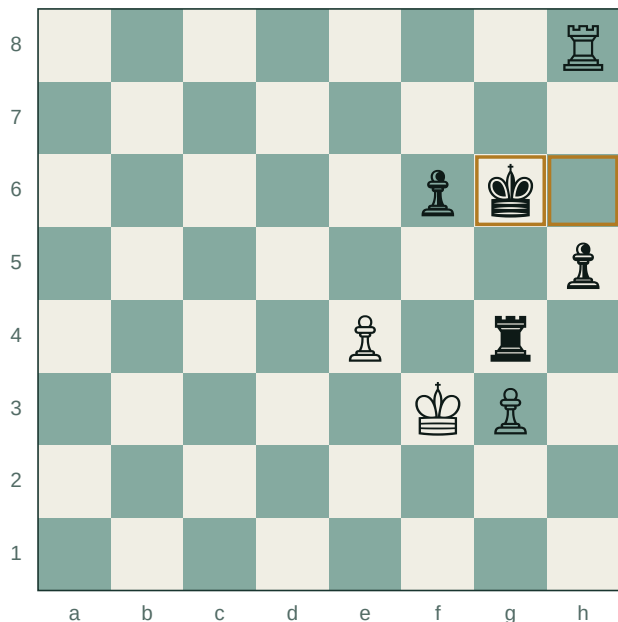


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 57

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 56...Kg6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

57. Rg8+ Kf7 58. Rxcg4 hxcg4+ 59. Kxcg4

57.Rg8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **57...Kf7**.

58.Rxcg4 The rook captures the rook on g4. Recorded reply: **58...hxcg4+**.

59.Kxcg4 The king captures the pawn on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.